



NEW MCFD RESIDENTIAL CARE PROGRAM OPENING CHECKLIST & REQUIRED DOCUMENTS — BRITISH COLUMBIA

*Staffed children's residential resource under the CFCSA, MCFD SHSS Standards, and (where 3+ youth)
CCALA licensing*

Document Reference	ECC-NEWPGM-2026-001
Proposed Program Name / Address	
Proposed Capacity (beds)	
Target Opening Date	
Project Lead	
Key Note	A community care facility licence is required whenever care is provided to 3 or more persons not related to the operator — through the regional health authority's Community Care Facilities Licensing office. 1–2 bed contracted homes are governed by the MCFD contract and SHSS but are not CCALA-licensed. Requirements vary by health authority and municipality — confirm locally before committing to a property.

Contents

PHASE 1 — Business & Legal Foundation

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Incorporate or confirm good standing: BC society or company registration (Registrar of Companies / Societies); annual reports current	BC Registries; SHSS H.1.4		
☐	Business licence for the municipality of the proposed program	Local government		
☐	Board resolution / owner authorization to open the new program	Corporate governance		
☐	Comprehensive General Liability insurance (covering employees, casuals, students, volunteers); property insurance for the premises; vehicle insurance minimum \$1M third-party liability	SHSS H.1.9, F.1		
☐	Accounting system per GAAP: budget for the new program; banking; payroll registration (CRA, WorkSafeBC employer registration, EHT as applicable)	SHSS H.1.8; CRA; WorkSafeBC		
☐	WorkSafeBC coverage confirmed for the new location	Workers Compensation Act		

PHASE 2 — MCFD Procurement & Contract

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Register on BC Bid and MCFD e-Service notifications; identify the current Request for Qualification (RFQ) / Request for Proposal (RFP) for staffed children's residential services in the target Service Delivery Area	BC Bid; MCFD Contract Management		
☐	Prepare the proposal package: program description, service model, staffing model (per MCFD Staffed Residential Model and Standard Price Structure Guide), budget, organizational capacity, references	MCFD Standard Price Structure Guide		
☐	Demonstrate compliance capacity with the Standards for Staffed Children's Residential Services (SHSS) — policies, staffing, records	SHSS (rev. April 2026)		
☐	Engage the MCFD Resource/Procurement contact for the SDA; confirm bed need, population, and any Indigenous community partnership expectations (An Act respecting First Nations, Inuit and Métis children, youth and families)	MCFD SDA office		
☐	Negotiate and execute the MCFD service agreement (Schedule A service requirements; Terms and Conditions for MCFD Service Agreements); note contract deliverables and reporting	MCFD contract		
☐	Obtain written MCFD approvals required before placements (including CCALA s.19(2) director approval before any under-19 youth is brought into BC to become a person in care)	CCALA s.19(2); CFCSA		

PHASE 3 — Property, Municipal & Fire

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Secure the premises: own, lease permitting a community care facility, or written owner authorization (a licence applicant must have legal authority over the premises)	CCALA; RCR		
☐	Zoning / bylaw confirmation from local government for a residential care use at the address; strata bylaws checked if applicable	Local government		
☐	Building safety: occupancy requirements, any required building permits for modifications	BC Building Code; municipality		
☐	Fire inspection of the premises by the local fire authority; written fire clearance / Letter of Assurance; deficiencies corrected	Fire Services Act; SHSS F.4.7(c)		
☐	Fire equipment installed: interconnected smoke alarms (bedrooms + corridors), extinguishers, emergency lighting, posted fire/emergency plan on each floor, clear exits	SHSS F.4.7		
☐	Environmental health approval where applicable: food service for larger capacity, septic system, well water testing	Health authority EHO		
☐	Physical plant meets Residential Care Regulation: bedrooms with opening windows, 1 toilet + basin per 5 persons in care, 1 tub/shower per 10, furnished activity space, private staff workspace, secure storage	RCR; SHSS F.2–F.3		

PHASE 4 — CCALA Licence (3+ beds) — Health Authority

Apply through the regional health authority Community Care Facilities Licensing office (Fraser, Vancouver Coastal, Island, Interior, or Northern Health). Start 4–6 months ahead — the licensing officer must investigate every application and timelines vary.

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Attend a licensing information session / pre-application meeting with the licensing office	Health authority licensing		
☐	Application for a Community Care Facility Licence — completed, signed (a legal document; ink)	CCALA; RCR		
☐	Statement of the proposed manager's qualifications, relevant work experience, and suitability (licensing must be satisfied the manager has the training, experience, ability, and temperament)	RCR; CCALA		
☐	Criminal record check authorizations (CRRRA) for the applicant (or manager where the applicant is a corporation) and staff; three references for the applicant/manager	CRRRA; RCR		
☐	Statement of the number of staff to be employed and their qualifications	RCR		
☐	Detailed program description: population served, ages, care model, daily routines, behaviour practices	RCR; SHSS A.1		
☐	Site plan and floor plans of the premises (rooms, dimensions, exits, bedroom assignments)	Health authority licensing		
☐	Fire clearance, zoning confirmation, and environmental health approvals attached	As Phase 3		
☐	Licensing officer facility inspection completed; deficiencies corrected; licence issued and displayed with the manager's name	CCALA; MHO		

PHASE 5 — Policies & Manuals (the program binder set)

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Written statement of purpose / program description (philosophy, admission criteria, orientation, complaints, behaviour practices, code of ethics, staffing model)	SHSS A.1		
☐	Policy and procedure manual suite adopted for the program: RC Program Manual; Behaviour Support Manual; OHS Binder; HR Policy Binder; PC and PM Manuals	SHSS H.1.5; ECC suite		
☐	Medication Administration Manual (ECC-MED-2026-001) + Implementation Binder; MARs, CDS count sheets, error/refusal/disposal forms stocked	RCR s.45–49; SHSS G.3, D.3		
☐	Comprehensive Staff Binder and role duty binders (CYW, PC, PM, ED) issued	ECC-STAFF-BND; - DUTY series		
☐	Reportable incident procedure with after-hours numbers posted (MCFD Centralized Screening 1-800-663-9122); complaint procedure copies for youth	SHSS C.2.8; B.2		
☐	Individual service record system ready (E.7.10 contents); daily log and wellness check formats; consent and PHN intake forms	SHSS E.7, C.1		
☐	Emergency plans: fire, earthquake, missing youth, medical emergency; Poison Control card posted (1-800-567-8911)	SHSS F.4; ECC-MED App E		

PHASE 6 — Staffing & Screening

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	PM and PC appointed; org chart and managerial list provided to MCFD	SHSS H.1.6–.7		
☐	Recruit to the funded staffing model; job descriptions per Joint Job Evaluation benchmarks / Appendix B minimum qualifications (or CSM-approved equivalents)	MCFD Price Structure Guide; SHSS G.1.9		
☐	Every staff member screened BEFORE unsupervised contact: CRRA criminal record check (MCFD CF0622B process where applicable), interview, personal + employment references, medical reference	SHSS G.1.7; Screening Policy		
☐	First aid certification for all direct-care staff; gender-affirming care training; orientation with written acknowledgements	SHSS G.3.6–.8, G.3.2(b)		
☐	MALM medication training, competency demonstrations, and written medication authorizations (Appendix A) before any medication duty	ECC-MED §4; SHSS G.3		
☐	Personnel files complete; payroll onboarding; schedules built to maintain ratios with an emergency staffing plan	SHSS G.1.10, G.2, G.4.7		

PHASE 7 — Facility Set-Up & Pre-Opening

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Medication room/cabinet installed: locked cabinet secured to structure; double-lock CDS box; medication fridge with min/max thermometer; key log; EpiPen location (unlocked, labelled)	ECC-MED §9–10, §23		
☐	Furnishings per RCR/SHSS: individual bedrooms/space, study space, secure storage for belongings, dining and activity areas	SHSS F.2–F.3		
☐	Hazardous products locked; scald protection verified (37–38°C bathing, max 42°C); first aid kit stocked	SHSS F.4.8–.9; C.1.6		
☐	Communications: dedicated program phone; emergency numbers posted beside each phone; on-call schedule posted	SHSS F.4.7; C.1.7		
☐	Vehicle ready: insured \$1M+, certified child restraints, driver abstracts on file	SHSS F.1		
☐	Pharmacy relationship established; prescriber contacts; blister-pack dispensing arranged	ECC-MED §40		
☐	Mock run: fire drill, medication count, reportable incident tabletop, documentation walkthrough with the full team	Best practice		
☐	MCFD contract manager / resource worker pre-opening walkthrough; licensing officer final inspection (licensed programs)	MCFD; health authority		

PHASE 8 — First 30 Days After Opening

✓	Requirement / Document	Authority / Source	Date Done	Initials
☐	Fire drill immediately following EACH placement (plus the monthly drill)	SHSS F.4.7(a)2		
☐	Admission package per youth within 72 hours: rights info, complaint procedure, orientation, consents/PHN, medication profile and MAR, care plan responsibilities started (draft ≤30 days)	SHSS B.1–B.2, E.1, E.4		
☐	Daily logs, wellness checks, and MAR audit trail running from day one	SHSS C.1; ECC-MED		
☐	First monthly cycle completed: facility inspection checklist, medication inventory, financial statement, ED binder review	ECC binder suite		
☐	Implementation Binder (ECC-MED-2026-001-IMP) checklists worked through and signed	ECC-MED-IMP		
☐	Confirm reporting lines live: reportable incidents tested with SW contact details; licensing officer contact posted	SHSS C.2.8		

Master Document List — What Must Be In Hand Before Opening

Corporate: incorporation/society certificate + good standing; business licence; insurance certificates (liability, property, vehicle); WorkSafeBC registration; budget and GAAP accounting; board authorization.

MCFD: executed service agreement with Schedule A; funded staffing model; MCFD approvals for placements; SHSS standards on site; org chart and managerial list filed with MCFD.

Property: lease/title or owner authorization; zoning confirmation; fire clearance / Letter of Assurance; environmental health approvals; site and floor plans.

Licence (3+ beds): CCALA community care facility licence displayed with manager's name.

People: completed screening file per staff member (CRC, references, medical reference); first aid certificates; orientation acknowledgements; MALM certificates and Appendix A medication authorizations; job descriptions; schedules.

Program: statement of purpose; full policy manual suite; medication manual and forms; service record system; emergency plans; posted contact cards (Poison Control, Centralized Screening, licensing officer, on-call).

Opening Sign-Off

All phases complete — Project Lead / Date	
Program Manager / Date	
Executive Director / Date	
MCFD walkthrough completed (name/date)	
Licence issued (number/date) — if applicable	